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# LONG AVENUE PEDESTRIAN AND TRAFFIC SAFETY ASSESSMENT

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## COMMUNITY SAFETY REPORT

**Prepared by a Resident of the 30th Ward**

**Community Meeting: Rethinking Long Avenue  
30th Ward District of Chicago**

April 2025

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## **1 Summary**

This report addresses critical pedestrian and traffic safety concerns along the North Long Avenue corridor between Warwick Avenue and Patterson Avenue in Chicago, Illinois. Observations indicate a notable absence of pedestrian-aware signage, obscured stop signage, and routine noncompliance with existing traffic controls, posing immediate risks to pedestrians—particularly given the proximity to local schools and residential housing. Prompt and practical measures have already been initiated through the City of Chicago’s 311 service requests, including clearing obstructive vegetation around existing stop signage (SR25-00689858) and the installation of pedestrian crossing signage at key intersections lacking appropriate visual cues (SR25-00689945, SR25-00689968, SR25-00689984). This report recommends swift implementation of these signage improvements and enhanced visibility measures as low-cost, high-impact interventions to mitigate risks and enhance public safety for all roadway users.

## **2 Introduction/Background**

North Long Avenue serves as a minor arterial street within a residential neighborhood of Chicago, characterized by moderate vehicular traffic, active pedestrian movement, and proximity to educational institutions. The corridor between Warwick Avenue and Patterson Avenue is heavily utilized by families, children commuting to nearby schools, and local residents engaging in daily activities.

The area is notably close to William P. Gray Elementary School, located at 3730 N Laramie Avenue, approximately one block east of Long Avenue at the intersection of Lockwood and Warwick. The school’s presence strongly indicates a high volume of child pedestrian activity in the immediate vicinity. In addition, Portage Park—a major public park serving families, teenagers, and adults—is situated nearby, further contributing to consistent pedestrian flows. Residents frequently travel southbound on Long Avenue from Irving Park Road toward their homes, making Long a natural conduit for mixed vehicular and pedestrian traffic.

Previous concerns have been informally raised by community members regarding driver noncompliance with stop signs and unsafe vehicular speeds, yet comprehensive traffic calming or pedestrian-oriented improvements have not been systematically implemented to date. The conditions documented in this report were observed during multiple field visits conducted in April 2025.

### 3 Problem Identification

The following critical issues were identified through direct observation:

- **Obstructed Stop Sign:** At the northwest corner of North Long Avenue and West Warwick Avenue, a key stop sign is partially hidden by overgrown tree branches, reducing visibility for southbound drivers until the final approach to the intersection. This condition undermines driver compliance and increases collision risk.
- **Absence of Pedestrian Signage:** At several intersections, including Long & Dakin, Long & Berenice, and Long & Patterson, there is no pedestrian crossing signage. These locations lack stop controls and leave pedestrians exposed to vehicle traffic with minimal warning to drivers.
- **Routine Stop Sign Noncompliance:** Informal observations suggest a consistent pattern of drivers failing to come to a complete stop at existing stop-controlled intersections, even in proximity to a school and park. This behavior heightens risks for pedestrians, particularly young children and families.

These problems collectively diminish the overall safety of the corridor for non-motorized users and suggest an urgent need for targeted interventions to address infrastructure deficiencies and reinforce compliance among roadway users.

### 4 Action Taken

In response to the identified concerns, proactive measures were undertaken to initiate corrective actions through official city channels:

- **Obstructed Stop Sign Reported:**
- **Missing Pedestrian Signage Reported:** Three separate 311 service requests were filed to report the absence of pedestrian crossing signage at the following intersections:
  - Long Avenue and Dakin Street (Service Request No. SR25-00689984)
  - Long Avenue and Berenice Avenue (Service Request No. SR25-00689968)
  - Long Avenue and Patterson Avenue (Service Request No. SR25-00689945)

Each request highlighted the absence of signage and the heightened risk posed to pedestrians, requesting investigation and appropriate corrective action.

- **Field Documentation:** Photographic documentation of the obstructed stop sign and intersections lacking pedestrian crossing signage was gathered during field visits in

April 2025. Observations of traffic behavior were informal and are noted without formal traffic studies.

These preliminary actions create a foundation for further intervention and serve as formal documentation of citizen-initiated efforts to improve local traffic and pedestrian safety.

## 5 Recommendations

Based on the conditions observed and actions already initiated, the following recommendations are proposed to enhance pedestrian and traffic safety along the North Long Avenue corridor:

- **Restore Full Visibility of Existing Stop Sign (Immediate):** Expedite trimming or removal of vegetation obstructing the stop sign at North Long Avenue and West Warwick Avenue to restore full visibility and ensure driver compliance.
- **Installation of MUTCD-Compliant Pedestrian Crossing Signage:** Deploy highly visible W11-2 “Pedestrian Crossing” signs at the intersections of Long & Dakin, Long & Berenice, and Long & Patterson, positioned at both driver eye-level and elevated heights wherever vegetation will not obstruct visibility; funding can be drawn from the ward’s discretionary infrastructure budget and coordinated with routine sign-repair scheduling for rapid implementation.
- **Supplementary Visibility Enhancements:** Evaluate the feasibility of additional low-cost enhancements such as reflective pavement markings or solar-powered flashing pedestrian signs at uncontrolled crossings to further alert drivers to pedestrian presence.
- **Request CAPS-Supported Targeted Enforcement:** Encourage ongoing community involvement by establishing periodic local traffic safety audits. Engaging residents aligns with participatory governance principles and ensures future issues are surfaced proactively.
- **Request CAPS-Supported Targeted Enforcement (Bridge Measure):** Coordinate with the local CAPS office for periodic stop-sign enforcement days, emphasizing education over citation; pairing limited police presence with community ambassadors supports “treatment-not-trauma” public-safety principles while deterring habitual non-compliance.

## 6 Conclusion

The North Long Avenue corridor presents clear and addressable safety deficiencies that disproportionately affect children, families, and other vulnerable road users traveling between William P. Gray Elementary School, Portage Park, and surrounding residences. Immediate actions—trimming vegetation that blocks critical signage and installing MUTCD-compliant pedestrian crossing signs—can be executed swiftly and at minimal cost through existing ward infrastructure funds. Complementary short-term measures such as a quick-build safety audit, youth-led crosswalk projects, targeted CAPS enforcement, and a public 311 transparency dashboard will reinforce driver compliance, promote community ownership, and align with the ward’s goals of participatory budgeting and data-informed governance.

Timely implementation of these recommendations will not only reduce collision risk but also demonstrate a tangible commitment to equitable, community-driven improvements. I am available to collaborate with your office on next steps—such as site walks, additional documentation, or community outreach—as needed, and look forward to supporting swift action on these low-cost, high-impact solutions.

## 7 Photo Evidence



Figure 1: Absence of pedestrian crossing signage at Long & Dakin. (Filed as 311 SR No. SR25-00689984)





Figure 2: Obstructed stop sign at the northwest corner of Long & Warwick. Vegetation blocks driver visibility traveling southbound. (Filed as 311 Service Request No. SR25-00689858)



Figure 3: Close-up view showing tree obstruction directly impacting visibility of stop sign at Long & Warwick. (Filed as 311 SR No. SR25-00689858)





Figure 4: View facing northbound on Long and eastbound on Berenice; no pedestrian crossing signage or markings. (Filed as 311 SR No. SR25-00689968)



Figure 5: Northbound view on Long Avenue approaching Berenice; intersection lacks pedestrian accommodations.





Figure 6: Wide view of Long & Patterson intersection showing absence of pedestrian crossing signage or pavement markings. (Filed as 311 SR No. SR25-00689945)

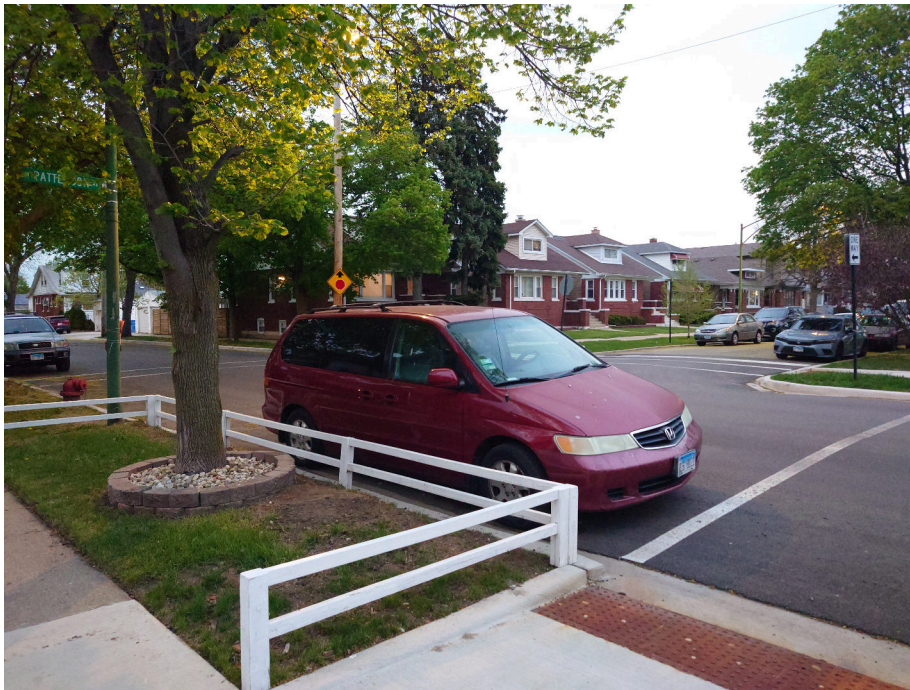


Figure 7: Closer view of Long & Patterson intersection, reinforcing absence of pedestrian safety infrastructure.